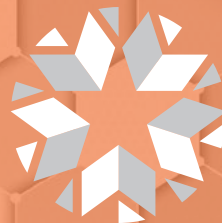


OKLAHOMA SCHOOL TESTING PROGRAM

TEST BLUEPRINT AND ITEM SPECIFICATIONS
GRADE 3 ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS



OKLAHOMA
Education

Read this passage. Then answer the questions that follow.

Gone Fishing

by Kristine O’Connell George

cattails—tall plants with flat leaves that grow near water

- 1 No one else was awake
when we got up at dawn
to go fishing.
Walking the steep path
- 5 down to the lake,
we could see the circle flop
and splash of trout. I warned
my little brother not to go
too close to the edge.
- 10 He said:
*You can’t tell **me** what to do.*
No one else was awake
when we got up at dawn
to go fishing. All I caught
- 15 was one little brother—
hauled up out of the cattails,
sputtering, soggy, and still stubborn.

“Gone Fishing” from TOASTING MARSHMALLOWS: Camping Poems by Kristine O’Connell George. Text copyright © 2001 by Kristine O’Connell George. Reprinted by permission of Clarion Books, an imprint of Houghton Mifflin Harcourt Publishing Company. All rights reserved.

1 “Gone Fishing” is mainly about

- A** trout splashing in a lake.
- B** children not catching a fish.
- C** a child not listening to a warning.
- D** a speaker giving orders to a brother.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

3.2.R.1: Students will determine the main idea and supporting details of a text.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must comprehend and process the poem in order to determine the main idea of the poem. The student must understand that the children are going fishing, that the younger brother is warned to be careful and disregards that warning, and that he pays the price.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This describes what the children see as they approach the lake, but this is not what the poem is mainly about.
- B. Based on the poem, the children never had an opportunity to try to catch a fish before the little brother fell in the lake.
- C. Correct. The little brother was warned by the speaker not to get too close to the edge of the lake, but he stubbornly ignored the speaker and fell into the lake.**
- D. Though the speaker tried to warn the little brother about getting too close to the edge of the lake, the poem is not focused on the speaker's orders.

2 How does the reader know “Gone Fishing” is a poem?

- A** It has characters.
- B** It contains sentences.
- C** It could really happen.
- D** It is arranged by stanzas.

Standard 2: Students will read and comprehend inclusive, diverse, and increasingly complex literary and informational texts.

3.2.R.2: Students will identify elements of various genres in fiction, poetry, and nonfiction texts.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must understand the differences between genres and then apply that knowledge to the passage to determine its genre.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Characters may be found in nonfictional and informational text, so this is not a unique feature of poetry.
- B. Nonfiction and fiction texts have sentences, and in this case the poem does too.
- C. Events that could really happen may be represented in nonfiction, fiction, and poetry.
- D. Correct. Poetry has a unique organizational structure; it is organized by stanzas.**

3 Why did the author most likely write the poem?

- A to persuade readers that fishing is fun
- B to inform readers about how to catch a fish
- C to tell readers about a lake two children discover
- D to entertain readers with an experience two children share

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

3.3.R.1: Students will determine if the author's purpose is to entertain, inform, or persuade.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 3

This item is a DOK 3 because it requires the student not only to comprehend the poem but also analyze its different aspects. The student must have a deep understanding of the poem yet go beyond the text to answer the question.

Distractor Rationale

- A. The author does not use persuasive language to tell about fishing.
- B. The poem tells about children who are going fishing; it does not provide directions about how to catch a fish.
- C. The children in the poem already know about the lake; they do not discover it.
- D. Correct. The poem tells a story about two siblings who have an amusing experience.

4 The reader knows the poem is told from the first-person point of view because

- A the speaker names a type of fish.
- B the speaker is a part of the action.
- C the speaker tells about a real place.
- D the speaker is describing a family member.

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

3.3.R.2: Students will determine whether a grade-level literary text is narrated in first- or third-person point of view.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This is a DOK 1 because the student is recalling features of text told in the first person.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This is not a feature of first-person point of view.
- B. Correct. The speaker is the sibling who rescues the boy when he falls into the lake.
- C. This is not a feature of first-person point of view.
- D. This is not a feature of first-person point of view.

5 Which word best describes how the speaker feels at the end of "Gone Fishing"?

- A** upset
- B** strong
- C** curious
- D** alarmed

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

3.3.R.5: Students will answer inferential questions, using a text to support answers.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 3

This item is a DOK 3 because it requires the student not only to comprehend the poem but also analyze its speaker. The student must have a deep understanding of the poem yet go beyond the text and make inferences to answer the question.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** As the speaker is hauling the little brother out of the lake, the words "still stubborn" in reference to the boy, indicates the speaker's unhappiness with the situation.
- B.** There is no indication in the poem that the speaker felt strong as the boy was pulled out of the lake.
- C.** There is no indication in the poem that the speaker became alarmed when the boy fell in the lake.
- D.** There is no indication in the poem that the speaker was satisfied that the boy fell in the lake and was being pulled out.

6 Explain why the speaker of the poem can be described as helpful. Provide details from the poem to support your answer.

Standard 3: Students will analyze, interpret, and evaluate increasingly complex literary and informational texts that include a wide range of historical, cultural, ethnic, and global perspectives from a variety of genres.

3.3.R.3: Students will find examples of literary elements:

- setting
- plot
- characters
- characterization

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2. The student has a strong understanding of the poem, and of the speaker in particular. Then the student is able to identify particular details of the poem that illustrate why the speaker is helpful. This is a written response rather than a choice response.

Correct Response:

Score	Description
2	The response fully explains why the speaker of the poem can be described as helpful. The details provided to support the description are based on the text and are relevant to the task.
1	The response explains or attempts to explain why the speaker of the poem can be described as helpful, but the supporting details may lack specificity or the explanation is not supported by the text.
0	The response does not fulfill the requirements of the task. The response is incorrect, irrelevant, or missing.
Blank	

Possible responses:

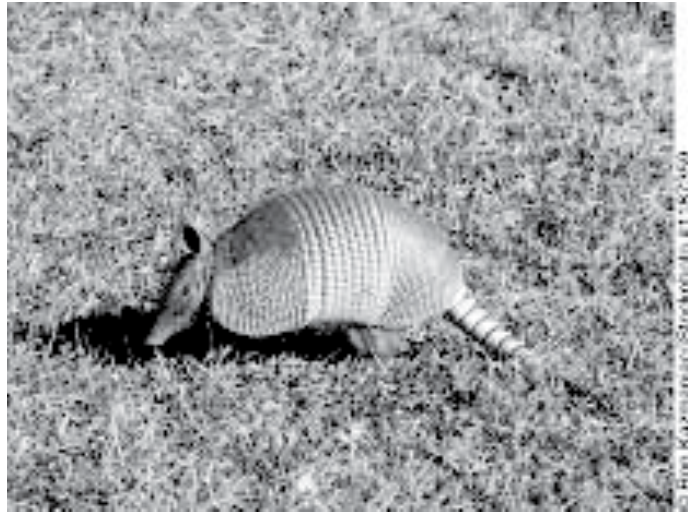
- The speaker wants to help the little brother to stay safe.
- “I warned / my little brother not to go / too close to the edge.” (lines 7-9)
- The speaker helps the little brother after he falls in the water.
- “All I caught / was one little brother— /hauled up out of the cattails, /sputtering, soggy, and still stubborn.” (lines 14-17)

Other responses are acceptable if supported by relevant details from the text.

Read this passage. Then answer the questions that follow.

Look! It's an Armadillo!

- 1 Have you ever seen an armadillo? Most people in the United States never will. But if you live in Oklahoma, you just might get the chance!
- 2 Armadillos are the most unusual animals ever! If you ever see an armadillo, the first thing you'll notice is that it's covered in leathery scales. It may even remind you of the shell of a turtle. These gray scales are hard and strong. They protect armadillos from their enemies and other dangerous things in their environment such as thorns.



The word “armadillo” means “little armored one” in Spanish. It is the perfect name for this little creature because it has bony scales that cover it from head to tail. Believe it or not, armadillos are the only living mammals that have shells like this. Their shells often lead people to believe they are related to turtles. This lack of fur explains why armadillos live in warm climates.

- 3 Armadillos also have short legs and long bodies. Even though they are close to the ground, adult armadillos can be over 2½ feet long, including their stringy tails. That's about as long as your leg.
- 4 You might think armadillos are related to turtles because of their shells. Don't be fooled, though! Armadillos are mammals, like cats, dogs, and people. However, it is their shells that make the curious animals different.

- 5 Many mammals are covered in fur that keeps them warm like a winter coat. Not armadillos! Their shells are sturdy, but the shells don't protect them from freezing temperatures. That is why armadillos have to be careful about where they live; don't waste your time searching for armadillos in Alaska or Maine! It's too cold for them to live there. Oklahoma, on the other hand, is a great place for these creatures. They can also be found in Texas, Louisiana, and Florida.
- 6 Armadillos need good weather, but they also need to live where the soil is soft. Armadillos make their homes in holes in the ground called burrows. Although the animals have long, sharp claws perfect for digging, a cold climate can make the dirt difficult to get through. These burrows are extremely important to armadillos. They use them to live in, raise their families, and hide from other animals.
- 7 The ground isn't just an armadillo home—it's also a supermarket! Armadillos dig for their food. They often feast on insects, worms, and lizards. They also eat plant roots and berries. If they can't dig, they can't survive.
- 8 Like any wild animal, armadillos have **predators**. Sometimes, coyotes chase them. Other times, humans hunt them because they destroy crops while digging for food. Many people love armadillos, however. Some kind farmers trap the pesky creatures and release them far away from their crops. There is also a town that loves armadillos so much that it celebrates Armadillo Day. You might even see an armadillo race at a county fair.
- 9 Don't forget—you could spot an armadillo in your own backyard. It might be wandering in the woods or grazing in your garden right now. Seeing an armadillo is something most kids in the United States will never experience.

7 A student wants to write a report about armadillo babies.

What should the student do first?

- A** create a graphic organizer to help arrange the information
- B** create a rough draft that contains key information
- C** ask a friend to edit the report for mistakes
- D** publish the report for others to read

Standard 2: Students will engage in a recursive process that may include prewriting, drafting, revising, editing, and publishing.

3.2.W.1: Students will routinely use a recursive process to prewrite, organize, and develop narrative, informative, and opinion drafts that display evidence of paragraphing.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This item is a DOK 1 because the student identifies which choice is first in the writing process.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** Usually students will create a graphic organizer to help organize their thoughts into a logical order.
- B.** Creating a rough draft is at the beginning of the writing process, but this step usually cannot be taken until information is gathered and organized.
- C.** The first step in writing is typically the pre-writing stage. Asking a friend to edit the report comes later in the process after a draft has been written.
- D.** Publishing is the final step of the writing process.

Drag **two** sentences into the paragraph to create an organized paragraph.

To place a sentence in the paragraph, click and hold the sentence, and then drag it to the desired space.

When baby armadillos leave the burrow, then the mothers can rest.

Armadillos are able to hold their breath for as long as six minutes!

They usually have four babies at one time!

There are more than 21 different kinds of armadillos.

Armadillos use their noses to find food in the wild.

Mother armadillos are very busy. Mother armadillos usually give birth to their babies, or pups, in the spring.

Mother armadillos keep their young in their burrows. This helps keep them safe. When they are a few weeks old, baby armadillos can leave the burrow. Mother armadillos provide milk to their pups until they are about 2 months old. They only stay with their mothers for a few months.

Standard 2: Students will engage in a recursive process that may include prewriting, drafting, revising, editing, and publishing.

3.2.W.2: Students will routinely use a recursive process to revise content for clarity, coherence, and organization (e.g., logical order and transitions).

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student applies knowledge of how to create a logical flow of information to an incomplete text.

Distractor Rationale

Drag **two** sentences into the paragraph to create an organized paragraph.

To place a sentence in the paragraph, click and hold the sentence, and then drag it to the desired space.

Armadillos are able to hold their breath for as long as six minutes!

There are more than 21 different kinds of armadillos.

Armadillos use their noses to find food in the wild.

Mother armadillos are very busy. Mother armadillos usually give birth to their babies, or pups, in the spring.

They usually have four babies at one time!

Mother armadillos keep their young in their burrows. This helps keep them safe. When they are a few weeks old, baby armadillos can leave the burrow. Mother armadillos provide milk to their pups until they are about 2 months old. They only stay with their mothers for a few months.

When baby armadillos leave the burrow, then the mothers can rest.

Select the **two** correctly spelled words that complete the sentence.

To select a word, click the menu and then click the desired word. To choose a different word, click the menu and click the new word.

They armadillos are the most
 animal in the world

believe
 beleive
 beleave

They armadillos are the most
 animal in the world

butiful
 beatiful
 beutiful
 beautiful

Standard 2: Students will engage in a recursive process that may include prewriting, drafting, revising, editing, and publishing.

3.2.W.3: Students will routinely and recursively edit drafts for punctuation, capitalization, and correctly-spelled grade-level words, using resources as needed.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

Depth-of-Knowledge: This item is a DOK 1 because the student is recalling the correct spelling of grade-level words.

Distractor Rationale

They armadillos are the most
 animal in the world

- 10** Which word from paragraph 2 has a similar meaning to the word **predators** in paragraph 9?
- A** animals
 - B** scales
 - C** enemies
 - D** thorns

Standard 4: Students will expand their grade-level vocabularies through reading, word study, and class discussion.

3.4.R.1: Students will identify relationships among words, including synonyms, antonyms, homophones, and homographs.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must know the definition of a specific word and then identify a different word with a similar meaning.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Some animals might be classified as predators, but not all animals are predators. The words are different in meaning.
- B. An armadillo's scales help protect the armadillo from predators.
- C. Correct. An animal that hunts other animals would not be considered friendly.**
- D. Thorns may harm an animal, but it is not actively hunting it.

- 11** Knowing the meaning of the prefix **un-** helps the reader to know that the word **unusual** means
- A** beyond usual.
 - B** usual before.
 - C** usual again.
 - D** not usual.

Standard 4: Students will expand their grade-level vocabularies through reading, word study, and class discussion.

3.4.R.3: Students will use word parts (e.g., affixes, Anglo-Saxon roots, stems) to define and determine the meaning of new words.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 1

This item is a DOK 1 because the student needs to know the meaning of a word when a prefix is added.

Distractor Rationale

- A. The prefix super- means "beyond."
- B. The prefix pre- means "before."
- C. The prefix re- means "again."
- D. Correct. The prefix un- means "not."**

12 Read the definition for the word **waste**.

waste *verb*. 1. to slowly destroy 2. to cause something to weaken in size or strength 3. to use in a foolish way 4. to slowly wear away

Which definition of the word **waste** is used in paragraph 5?

- A** definition 1
- B** definition 2
- C** definition 3
- D** definition 4

Standard 4: Students will expand their grade-level vocabularies through reading, word study, and class discussion.

3.4.R.4: Students will consult reference materials (e.g., dictionaries, glossaries, thesauruses) to comprehend the words in a text.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must discern how the word is being used in context and then identify which definition most closely fits that meaning.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Looking for armadillos where they will not be found does not slowly destroy the seeker's time.
- B. A person's time is not being weakened by looking for something that will not be found.
- C. **Correct.** Since armadillos cannot be found in colder areas, looking for them there would be to use time "in a foolish way."
- D. Looking for armadillos where they will not be found does not wear away the seeker's time.

13 Which information can **only** be found in the caption?

- A** the meaning of the word armadillo
- B** the reason armadillos live in warm places
- C** that the armadillo is a mammal with scales
- D** that people think armadillos are related to turtles

Standard 6: Students will gather, comprehend, evaluate, and synthesize researched information to acquire and refine knowledge.

3.6.R.2: Students will identify and use text features (e.g., graphics, captions, subheadings, italics, charts, tables, legends) to comprehend informational texts.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must compare and contrast information in two places to determine which information is only located in a single place.

Distractor Rationale

- A. **Correct.** The meaning of the word armadillo can only be found in the caption.
- B. This information can also be found in paragraph 5.
- C. This information can also be found in paragraph 5.
- D. This information can also be found in paragraph 4.

- 14** After reading the passage, a student still has questions about armadillo behavior and wants to do further research.

Which question would help them find new information?

- A** What do armadillos do during the winter?
- B** Why do armadillos have sharp claws?
- C** Why do armadillos prefer soft soil?
- D** What do armadillos like to eat?

Standard 6: Students will gather, comprehend, evaluate, and synthesize researched information to acquire and refine knowledge.

3.6.R.1: Students will conduct research to answer questions, including self-generated questions, and to build knowledge.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 3

This item is a DOK 3 because the student must evaluate which question would lead to information beyond the information in the passage.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** The passage does not provide any information about how armadillos act during winter months.
- B.** Paragraph 6 explains that armadillos need sharp claws for digging.
- C.** Paragraph 6 states that armadillos make their homes in burrows, so they need soil that is easy to dig.
- D.** As noted in paragraph 7, armadillos eat, “insects, worms, and lizards” and “plant roots and berries.”

15 Read the question a student wrote after reading the passage.

How do armadillos care for their young?

What is the **best** source the student could learn the answer to their question?

- A** a book about animals with protective shells
- B** an online encyclopedia article about mammals
- C** a website that gives information about armadillo races
- D** an interview with a zookeeper who cares for armadillos

Standard 6: Students will gather, comprehend, evaluate, and synthesize researched information to acquire and refine knowledge.

3.6.R.3: Students will begin to determine the relevance of the information gathered.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 3

This item is a DOK 3 because the student needs to evaluate each source listed and make a determination about which source would contain the desired information.

Distractor Rationale

- A. This resource would likely not provide detailed information about the way armadillos care for their young.
- B. This source is too broad because it deals with all mammals—not just armadillos.
- C. The student's question is about armadillo young—not about armadillo races.
- D. **Correct.** Speaking with someone who works with armadillos would provide detailed information about armadillo babies.

16 Read the sentence.

The two trees leaves are turning brown.

What change, if any, should be made to trees in the sentence?

- A** tree's
- B** trees'
- C** treeses
- D** no change

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to speak and write effectively, demonstrating standard usage when appropriate.

3.5.W.5: Students will use apostrophes to form complex contractions (e.g., should've, won't, y'all) and to show possession.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must recall the rules regarding possessive plurals and apply them.

Distractor Rationale

- A. In the sentence "trees" is plural noun and needs an apostrophe added after the "s" to make it possessive.
- B. Correct. In the sentence "trees" is plural noun and needs an apostrophe added after the "s" to make it possessive.**
- C. In the sentence "trees" is plural noun and needs an apostrophe added after the "s" to make it possessive.
- D. In the sentence "trees" is plural noun and needs an apostrophe added after the "s" to make it possessive.

17 Read the sentence.

Doe'snt your uncle live near your grandmother?

What change, if any, should be made to Doe'snt in the sentence?

- A** Does'nt
- B** Do'esnt
- C** Doesn't
- D** no change

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to speak and write effectively, demonstrating standard usage when appropriate.

3.5.W.5: Students will use apostrophes to form complex contractions (e.g., should've, won't, y'all) and to show possession.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must recall the rules regarding contractions and apply them.

Distractor Rationale

- A. The contraction for "does not" needs an apostrophe to appear between the "n" and "t."
- B. The contraction for "does not" needs an apostrophe to appear between the "n" and "t."
- C. Correct. The contraction for "does not" needs an apostrophe to appear between the "n" and "t."**
- D. The contraction for "does not" needs an apostrophe to appear between the "n" and "t."

18 Read the sentence.

Ed must be home by dinner.

What changes should be made to the sentence to make it an interrogative sentence?

- A** Will Ed be home by dinner?
- B** Be home by dinner, Ed.
- C** Oh, Ed is home for dinner!
- D** Ed will eat dinner at home.

Standard 5: Students will expand and apply knowledge of grammar, usage, mechanics, and style to speak and write effectively, demonstrating standard usage when appropriate.

3.5.W.1: Students will compose simple and compound declarative, interrogative, imperative, and exclamatory sentences, avoiding and correcting fragments.

Depth-of-Knowledge: 2

This item is a DOK 2 because the student must recall the different types of sentences and their punctuation then apply that information to this sentence.

Distractor Rationale

- A. Correct.** This sentence is asking a question about Ed, which makes it interrogative.
- B.** This sentence is commanding Ed to be home, which makes it an imperative sentence.
- C.** This sentence is showing surprise or joy that Ed is home for dinner, making it an exclamatory sentence.
- D.** This sentence is stating the fact that Ed will eat at home, which makes it a declarative sentence.

